

From the Edinburgh Review.

1. *Des Pensées de Pascal. Rapport à L'Académie Française sur la nécessité d'une nouvelle édition de cet ouvrage. Par M. V. COUSIN.* 8vo. Paris: 1843.
2. *Pensées, Fragments, et Lettres de Blaise Pascal: publiés pour la première fois conformément aux manuscrits originaux, en grande partie inédits. Par M. PROSPER FAUGÈRE.* 2 vols. 8vo. Paris: 1844.

So much has been written of late years respecting Pascal, and so much that is worth reading, that we do not know that we should have been induced to make him the subject of present criticism, had it not been for the appearance of the above remarkable volumes of M. Faugère.

It seems strange to say, that the most popular work of an author who has been dead two hundred years, and who has obtained a world-wide reputation—a work which has passed through numberless editions, and been translated into most European languages—has never been published in an authentic form till now. Yet this is strictly true of the *Pensées de Pascal*.

It is not possible to convey to the reader a just idea of the merits of this improved edition, or the circumstances which led to it, without relating some of the more important incidents of Pascal's life. A formal biography, however, it cannot be necessary to give; for who has not read some account of the life of Blaise Pascal? It will be sufficient briefly to advert to the principal facts of this great man's history, and the dates of their occurrence.

He was born at Clermont, in Auvergne, in the year 1623, and died in the year 1662, at the early age of thirty-nine. When we think of the achievements which he crowded into that brief space, and which have made his name famous to all generations, we may well exclaim with Corneille, "A peine a-t-il vécu, quel nom il a laissé!"

It is well-known that Pascal exhibited from the earliest childhood the most precocious proofs of inventive genius, especially in the department of mathematics. Having, if we may believe the universally received tradition, been willingly kept in ignorance of Geometry, lest his propensity in that direction should interfere with the prosecution of other branches of knowledge, his self-prompted genius discovered for itself the elementary truths of the forbidden science. At twelve years of age, he was surprised by his father in the act of demonstrating, on the pavement of an old hall, where he used to play, and by means of a rude diagram, traced by a piece of coal, a proposition which corresponded to the thirty-second of the first book of Euclid.* At the age of sixteen, he composed a little tractate on the Conic Sections, which provoked the mingled incredulity and admiration of Descartes. At nineteen, he invented his celebrated arithmetical machine; and at the age of six-and-twenty, he had composed the greater part of his

mathematical works, and made those brilliant experiments in Hydrostatics and Pneumatics which have associated his name with those of Torricelli and Boyle, and ranked him amongst the first philosophers of his age. Yet, strange to say, he now suddenly renounced the splendid career to which his genius so unequivocally invited him; and gave himself up to totally different studies. This was principally attributable to that strong religious impulse which was imparted to his mind at this period—rendered deeper by early experience in the school of affliction. From the age of eighteen, he was a perpetual sufferer. In 1647, when only in his twenty-fourth year, he was attacked by paralysis. His ill health was mainly, if not wholly, occasioned by his devotion to study; and of him it is literally true, that his mind consumed his body.

So complete was his abandonment of science, that he never returned to it but on one memorable occasion, and then only for a short interval. We allude, of course, to the remarkable problems which he solved respecting the curve called the Cycloid. The accounts which have been transmitted to us by his sister, of the manner in which these investigations were suggested and completed—accounts which are authenticated by a letter of his own to Fermat—strongly impress us with the vigor and brilliancy of his genius. We are assured that, after long abandonment of mathematics, his attention was directed to this subject by a casual train of thought, suggested in one of the many nights which pain made sleepless. The thoughts thus suddenly originated, his inventive mind rapidly pursued to all the brilliant results in which they terminated; and in the brief space of eight days the investigations were completed. Partly in compliance with the fashion of the age, and partly from the solicitation of his friend the Duke de Roannes, he concealed for a time the discoveries at which he had arrived, and offered the problems for solution to all the mathematicians of Europe, with a first and second prize to successful candidates. If no solution were offered in three months, Pascal promised to furnish his own. Several were forwarded, but as none, in the estimation of the judges, completely fulfilled the conditions of the challenge, Pascal redeemed his pledge by publishing his own, under the name of Amos Dettonville—an anagram of Louis de Montalte, the name under which the "Provincial Letters" had appeared. This was in 1658-9, when he was thirty-six years of age.

With this brief exception, Pascal may be said to have practically abandoned science from the age of twenty-six. Yet he did not at once become a religious recluse. For some years he lived a cheerful, and even gay, though never a dissipated life, in Paris, in the centre of literary and polite society, loved and admired by a wide circle of friends, and especially by his patron, the Duke de Roannes. To the accomplished sister of this nobleman, M. Faugère conjectures (as we think plausibly) that Pascal was secretly attached, but, from timidity and humility, "never told his love." Perhaps, in part, from the melancholy which this hopeless attachment inspired, but certainly much more in consequence of the deeper religious convictions, produced

* His sister, Madame Perier, has left an interesting and circumstantial account of this matter, in the life of her brother.

THE ROYAL FAMILY OF FRANCE.

WE copy the following lively remarks on the state of society in Paris, at this time, from a late number of the *Courrier des Etats Unis*. It is from the Paris correspondent of that Journal.—*Daily Advertiser*.

"There is no longer any conversation in France," said a very spirited lady the other day in a drawing-room, where in fact there was no conversation. "Where will you find," continued she, "the smallest reminiscence, the feeblest reflection of the past century, of those charming parties which our worthy ancestors loved so much, those gay suppers, sparkling with wit and champagne?" Not certainly at the Tuileries; in that good citizen, family life, nothing corresponds to the traditions of the royal dignity of the olden time. The Sicilian devotion and anxiety, which form the normal state of the queen, prevent all gayety and joy from penetrating under the gilded hangings. No duenna could replace the watchfulness she extends over the young princesses, her daughters-in-law, whom she keeps always about her with an anxious and inquisitorial affection. When Madame Maintenon took for a sceptre and crown, a chaplet and breviary, the youth of the court deserted Versailles, and the Duke of Orleans gathered about him the nobility who resisted the devout rule of the royal favorite. To-day the Faubourg St. Germain, the only place where the traditions of the elegances of the past could be found, closes its saloons, retires within itself, and goes to plant its banner far from Paris. Finance and industry remain behind.

The queen, so respectable and so justly respected, has, however, a most unfortunately rigorous austerity, and which is to be regretted when we might have the most brilliant court in Europe. The princes are young, well educated, fond of the arts, the princesses are also young, and beautiful; the king is a man of fine mind, incessantly active, and it is said of a most amiable gayety. But all these precious elements are paralyzed and extinguished under the uneasy yoke of Maria Amelia. During the day, if the princesses wish to go out, they come and ask the permission of the queen, who inquires where they want to go; at what hour they will return, and then grants or refuses, as she sees fit. The dinner hour brings all the family together, when, after the repast is finished, the family repair to the saloon and take their places around the large table which is in the middle of the room. The queen seats herself between her two ladies of honor, and each of the princesses, also with their ladies, place themselves according to their rank. Before each is a drawer filled with needle work, and they all employ themselves with it, talking over the morning mass or the evening sermon. The king leans against the chimney, and talks with the person received, and when a new one is introduced, the other goes to pay his respects to the queen, who responds to his salutations more or less profoundly, according to the greater or less degree of favor the person enjoys with her; and the princess, under penalty of reprimand, must graduate their smile or salutation by that of the queen. At eleven o'clock the session is broken up, and every one retires to his apartment. The Duchess of Orleans lives entirely outside this royal phalanxtery; the illustrious widow of a prince so justly regretted, is a woman of the highest merit. The queen treats her as a heretic, and, in her Italian superstition, she attributes the death of her unfortunate son to

this union, cursed of Heaven. The king, who knows her superiority, would love her with all his heart, if she had not a right to the regency. Every evening, however, the Princess Helen comes to pay a visit to the family party, and stays with them a short hour. When she rises to return home, the king offers her his arm, and for a time they walk up and down the room talking together. The Duchess de Nemours is beautiful and insignificant; the Princess de Joinville is a very pretty young lady, very slender and entirely ignorant; a pleasant story is told of her. One day, on leaving the table, she wished, instead of entering the drawing-room, as usual, to go up into her own room. The queen opposed it. "Come with us, Francesca, my daughter," said she, endeavoring to draw her gently. "Oh, no, mamma, let me go, your drawing room m'embete," (stupefies me) replied the princess, withdrawing with a pouting air. The queen reprimanded her severely for this word; so out of place on the lips of a princess. "But, mamma," replied she, with simplicity, "Joinville says it all the time." It seemed that the Prince de Joinville added to the lessons given by the French master to the princess, a little sailor talk, which is quite droll. The Duchess Montpensier is a pretty child who does not know French, laughs at everybody, and nibbles chocolate all the time, which, to the great satisfaction of the marquis, grows more and more fashionable every day!

From the Boston Atlas.

A FEMALE CRUSOE.

OFF the coast of Alta California, about two degrees distant, bearing nearly west from Point San Pedro, which is in the latitude of 33° 43' N., and longitude 118° 14' W., will be found a small island, called by the Spaniards Saint Nicholas. This island was formerly inhabited by an inoffensive, indolent race of Indians, who subsisted almost entirely upon fish, which they caught from the rocks, and muscles, which they found in the sands of the beach. They were a listless, quiet race of beings, who seldom had communication with others of the human family, and who had but few wants and fewer cares.

About the year eighteen hundred and eighteen or twenty, the Russians, from their settlements at the North, landed on this island a party of Kodiak Indians, for the purpose of hunting the sea otter, which, at that period, abounded in those waters. This party remained on the island for more than two years; and were the means of sowing the seeds of disease and contention amongst its unsuspecting and unsophisticated inhabitants.

Some ten or twelve years after the departure of the Kodiaks, this tribe had become diminished to about twenty or thirty individuals, when the governor of the department of California sent over a small vessel and removed them to the main.

In the last boat, which was embarking with the last of this people, (some six or eight perhaps in number,) to convey them to the vessel, which was to carry them from the home of their nativity forever, was one of the tribe, small in stature, not far advanced in years, and his dusky mate, then in the bloom of life. The order had been given to shove from the shore; the oars had dipped in the wave, the boat was rising on the foaming surf, then breaking on the beach with awful roar, when with the impulse of the moment as it were, this young and blooming bride of the red man, the imprint of whose

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footstep had been the last left on the sands of her island home, waved an adieu to her chosen mate, plunged into the abyss, "strove through the surge," and, in another moment, stood alone on the shores of her native land. She turned, to give the last lingering look to her departing helpmate; and then, gathering around her from her flowing mantle, wet by the ocean-wave, in an instant disappeared forever from the sight of her astonished and sorrowing companions.

The vessel weighed anchor, spread her canvass; and, in forty-eight hours, this remnant of the inhabitants of San Nicholas were landed on Point San Pedro, houseless and forlorn.

From that period to the present—if she be not dead, or has not left within the past eighteen months—has resided alone, on the Isle of San Nicholas, this female Crusoe, the monarch of all she surveys. She preferred to part even with her chosen mate, and sever every human tie that could be binding, rather than leave the home of her birth—that lonely little isle, that had been to her a world, which she cared not to exchange for the abode of civilized man, with all its promised luxuries.

Since our Crusoe became the sole monarch of the isle, San Nicholas has been visited perhaps ten or twelve different times, by different individuals; but there she has continued to be found, with none to dispute her right—alone, solitary and forsaken.

Her dress, or covering, is composed of the skins of small birds, which she kills with stones, and sews them together with a needle of bone and the light sinews of the hair seal, sometimes found dead amongst the rocks. Her only food is a shell fish, of the muscle species, with now and then a still smaller fish, which the surf sometimes throws on to the beach. She never remains long in one spot; but is constantly wandering around the shores of the island, sleeping, which she seldom does, in small caves and crevices in the rocks.

During the few last years, it has been very difficult to obtain any communication with her. At the approach of the white man she flees, as from an evil spirit; and the only way to detain her, is by running her down, as you would the wild goat of the mountain, or the young fawn of the plains.

Those who have seen her at the latest period, report that she appears to have lost all knowledge of language; that she makes only a wild noise, altogether inhuman; and, when taken and detained against her will, becomes frightened and restless; that the moment she is liberated, she darts off, and endeavors to secrete herself in the wild grass, or amongst the rocks which hang over the never ceasing surf.

Every endeavor has been made, and every inducement offered, by different individuals, to prevail upon her to leave the island, but in vain. The only home she appears to desire, is her own little isle. Her last hope, if she has any, is, to finish her journey alone. She has no wish now, to hear again the sweet music of speech. Its sounds are no longer music to her ear—and, as for civilized man, his tameness is shocking even to her dormant senses.

To all appearance, she is strong, healthy, and content to be alone. What can reconcile her to her lot, who can conjecture? Humanity may hope that contentment may continue to be hers, to the last hour; for she is destined to lie down and die alone, on the cold shore of her isolated home, with no one to administer to her last wants, and none to cover her cold body, when the spirit shall have left the clay.

But the story of our Crusoe's chosen matè, the companion of her early life, has yet to be told. He saw her for the last time, as we have stated; when she stood alone on the shores of her own isle; when the boat with himself and his companions was dashing through the wild surf, that broke in uninterrupted succession against the rocks which encircled the resting place of his fathers, and which he was then leaving forever. With the remnant of the family from San Nicholas, our hero was landed at San Pedro, and there left, with the others who had accompanied him, to find a home in that land of strangers.

San Pedro, it may be known, is a bleak, barren, bluff point, running out into the blue waters of the Pacific, on which no verdure is to be seen, and but one solitary abode of man, rising amidst the desolation which surrounds it. The Pueblo de los Angeles is situated ten leagues distant, with one farm house between the one on the point and those of the town. The mission of San Gabriel lies yet farther on, some three or four leagues; where, at that time, might be found perhaps three or four hundred converted Indians.

But our hero, as he may be called, never left the beach on which he was first landed. Alone and friendless, there he remained, an isolated being, till life ceased to animate his frame. True it is, that several times he was induced, and once or twice forced, to venture as far as the Pueblo, and even the mission of San Gabriel; but he always, as soon as at liberty, returned and resumed his old station on the beach, or fixed himself on the rocks which hung around the Point. And there he might always be seen, a solitary outcast, as it were, and more constantly when the sun was going down, with his eyes gazing on that celestial orb as it sunk into the western horizon, a direction which he well knew pointed to the lost but never forgotten home of his nativity.

With difficulty he sustained the wants of nature by fishing about the rocks, gathering muscles, and sometimes receiving a scanty pittance of corn from the house on the Point, or a few pence from a passing stranger.

He studiously avoided, as far as possible, all intercourse with his fellow-man, and sought to live and die in solitude; and so did he continue to live a life which manifestly appeared a burthen to him, till one morning, as the sun rose, not two years past, his body was found on the beach a stiffened corse, stretched out, and bleaching, as it were, in the white foam of the surf, which was thrown about his lifeless remains as the mighty wave broke on the shore.

It is presumed his death was accidental—that whilst searching for shell-fish, in the night, amongst the cliffs, he must have fallen from an eminence, and thus terminated his solitary existence.

FIVE DAYS AT BERLIN.

We take the following passages from an interesting article by an eminent French writer, published in the *Paris Journal des Debats*.—*Daily Advertiser*.

* * * I enter Berlin by the Brandebourgh gate. It is one of the most beautiful city entrances in Europe. Frederic William II. erected it in 1789. It is eighty feet high. The form of it reminds one of the Propylea of Athens; it may perhaps be considered somewhat gigantic, considering the situation in which it is placed. Paris has its Berlin-street; Berlin has its Paris square, from which begins that

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